

Editor's Note

I. Structure of the Teacher's Manual

1. **Learning Objectives:** Each lesson has one theme; after completing the lesson, students will be able to express content related to that theme in Chinese.

2. **Key Teaching Points and Activity Design**

(1) Warm-Up Activities: Suggested warm-up methods to help the teacher introduce the lesson's theme.

(2) Vocabulary Instruction:

- a. Explain the meanings and usage scope of multi-meaning vocabulary within the lesson. For example, words like “還” (hái/huán), “給” (gěi), and “會” (huì) are practiced only in the sense used in the current lesson, without extending to other meanings or usages, to avoid unnecessary complexity that could confuse students.
- b. Vocabulary is divided into general words and phrases. “Phrases” are typically made up of several words that together carry a complete meaning, yet each individual word can also be used independently — for example: 貴姓 (your honorable surname), 您呢 (and you?), 哪國人 (person from which country), 臺灣人 (Taiwanese person). Phrases are structured as “貴 + 姓” or “臺灣 + 人.” To make it easier for students to learn and teachers to teach, it is best to teach and practice phrases as whole units. The English translations of vocabulary also follow this principle — translating the meaning of the whole phrase as it is used.
- c. Some vocabulary items can be used as separable words (referred to as “separable compounds” by Professor Zheng Shouxin and other scholars). These words are mostly verb-object constructions, such as: 教書 (teach), 跑步 (run), 看電視 (watch TV), 打網球 (play tennis). When both the verb and the noun have complete, extendable meanings and are used frequently, this textbook lists them as two separate words — e.g., 看／電視, 打／網球. Otherwise, they appear as a single word — e.g., 教書, 跑步, 說話. In Hanyu Pinyin, the verb-object structure (separable compound structure) is indicated by writing them separately.
- d. Notes on vocabulary items that students commonly misuse, provided for the teacher's reference.
- e. Suggested sequence for teaching vocabulary.

(3) Grammar Instruction:

- a. Explains the meaning and key points of each grammar pattern.
- b. Explains the meaning of each grammar pattern in the most accessible way possible, presents example sentences to show how the pattern is used, and then provides exercises to consolidate it. The grammar patterns selected are the most fundamental and are used with high frequency.

(4) Text Instruction:

- a. Lists the important sentences from the lesson; the teacher's instruction should focus on these sentences.
- b. Suggests a classroom teaching flow. The "segmented teaching" approach is recommended: present the text section by section in order, bringing out the vocabulary and grammar that appear in each section. Vocabulary is introduced based on teaching goals and does not have to follow the order of the vocabulary list — some items that appear later in the list can be introduced earlier, though the total number must be controlled. By segmenting this way, students in the first section can already engage in multi-faceted practice that includes vocabulary, grammar, and dialogue from the text. Then incorporate the first section into the second section, using the same interactive approach — a spiral, upward progression throughout the lesson.
- c. Provides comprehension questions for the text to enhance teacher-student interaction in the classroom.

(5) Integrated Activities:

- a. **Reading aloud and sight-reading the text:** The goal is to promote fluency and correct pronunciation, as well as to strengthen the ability to recognize Chinese characters.
- b. **Completing text sentences:** The goal is to consolidate the language of the text while also practicing writing Chinese characters. If writing characters is difficult, Zhuyin (Bopomofo) phonetic notation may be used as a substitute.
- c. **Communicative task activities:** Practicing listening and speaking through a variety of authentic interactive activities. Some lessons also use authentic materials to improve reading comprehension.

(6) Supplementary Text Instruction:

One to two supplementary practice materials are provided per lesson. These are dialogues or short passages rewritten to resemble the lesson text using the same vocabulary and grammar, for students to review. Teachers may use them as listening materials to train listening skills, or as reading materials to improve reading ability.

(7) Phonetics Instruction / Phonetics Review:

The complete textbook has a systematic phonetics curriculum that progressively teaches phonetics in lesson order. Teachers may use this system to teach students pronunciation and symbols before beginning Lesson 1. It is also possible to schedule the teaching of some phonetic symbols each week according to the lesson plan.

3. **Answer key for in-book exercises:** Includes answers for grammar exercises and integrated activity exercises.
4. **Answer key for the workbook:** Includes transcripts for listening exercises.
5. **Answer key for tests.**
6. **Supplementary online resources:** Including stroke-order grids, animated Chinese characters, and supplementary character activities.
7. **One copy of the test.**

8. **Chinese character writing practice:** Lists the Chinese characters to be practiced writing from the workbook.
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II. Guide to Using the Workbook

1. **Text Comprehension:** Assesses students' understanding of the lesson. Can be completed with teacher guidance in class or assigned as homework.
2. **Listening Practice:** Divided into two main sections. The first section focuses on distinguishing tones; the second section focuses on distinguishing Chinese characters, vocabulary, and sentences — practiced from the bottom up. Teachers may play the audio recording in class to complete some exercises, leaving the rest for students to practice at home. They may also practice once in class and once at home to reinforce listening training. Audio files for this textbook are available for free download.
3. **Restructuring Exercises:** Consolidates sentence patterns and grammar.
4. **Q&A Exercises:** Trains students to respond accurately and appropriately using a question-and-answer format.
5. **Picture Reading:** Uses pictures to train students' ability to read sentences and comprehend meaning.
6. **Translation:** A comprehensive, integrated exercise.
7. **Chinese Character Writing Practice:** Each lesson in the workbook practices writing 15–17 Chinese characters. The remaining characters are placed at the end of the teacher's manual.